OSHA Stair Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.25)

Use on a site walk-through of each stairway covered by 29 CFR 1910.25.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.25

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A; mark a whole section N/A when that stair type is not present.
2. For each Defect, record the stair location and what failed, report it for correction, and keep the stair out of use if it is unsafe to climb.
3. The manufacturer's instructions, 1910.28 rail rules and site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.25: Stairways (Part 1910 Subpart D, Walking-Working Surfaces) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-25-stairways

SECTION A | General stairway conditions

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Rails and guards Ref. 1910.25(b)(1)	Handrails, stair rails and guardrails installed as 1910.28 requires; none missing or removed	☐	☐	☐	
2	Overhead clearance Ref. 1910.25(b)(2)	At least 6 ft 8 in (203 cm) from each tread's front edge to the nearest overhead obstruction (spiral stairs: see section D)	☐	☐	☐	
3	Uniform steps Ref. 1910.25(b)(3)	Every riser in the flight the same height and every tread the same depth, including the first and last step before a landing	☐	☐	☐	
4	Landing width Ref. 1910.25(b)(4)	Each landing and platform is no narrower than the stair	☐	☐	☐	
5	Landing depth Ref. 1910.25(b)(4)	Landings and platforms measure 30 in (76 cm) or more in the direction of travel	☐	☐	☐	
6	Platform at doors and gates Ref. 1910.25(b)(5)	A platform exists wherever a door or gate opens directly onto the stair	☐	☐	☐	
7	Door swing, platform installed before January 17, 2017 Ref. 1910.25(b)(5)(i)	With the door or gate fully open, 20 in (51 cm) or more of usable platform depth remains	☐	☐	☐	
8	Door swing, platform installed on or after January 17, 2017 Ref. 1910.25(b)(5)(ii)	With the door or gate fully open, 22 in (56 cm) or more of usable platform depth remains	☐	☐	☐	
9	Load capacity Ref. 1910.25(b)(6)	Each stair can support at least five times the normal anticipated live load, and no less than 1,000 lb (454 kg) concentrated at any point	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Choice of stair type

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Routine travel routes Ref. 1910.25(b)(7)	Standard stairs serve every route between levels used regularly and routinely, including to equipment operating platforms	☐	☐	☐	
11	Winding stairs on tanks Ref. 1910.25(b)(7)	Any winding stairway is on a tank or similar round structure with a diameter of 5 ft (1.5 m) or more	☐	☐	☐	
12	Non-standard stair type justified Ref. 1910.25(b)(8)	Where spiral, ship or alternating tread stairs are used, the employer can show why standard stairs are not feasible at this location	☐	☐	☐	
13	Manufacturer's instructions Ref. 1910.25(b)(9)	Installation, use and maintenance of these non-standard stairs match the manufacturer's instructions	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Standard stairs

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
14	Stair angle Ref. 1910.25(c)(1)	Pitch measures 30 to 50 degrees from horizontal	☐	☐	☐	
15	Riser height Ref. 1910.25(c)(2)	No riser taller than 9.5 in (24 cm)	☐	☐	☐	
16	Tread depth Ref. 1910.25(c)(3)	No tread shallower than 9.5 in (24 cm)	☐	☐	☐	
17	Stair width Ref. 1910.25(c)(4)	22 in (56 cm) or more between vertical barriers	☐	☐	☐	
18	Older standard stairs (pre-January 17, 2017) Ref. 1910.25(c)(5)	Where risers or treads fall outside C2 or C3: dimensions match Table D-1, or the combination gives the 30 to 50 degree angle	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Spiral stairs

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
19	Clear width Ref. 1910.25(d)(1)	26 in (66 cm) or more of clear width	☐	☐	☐	
20	Riser height Ref. 1910.25(d)(2)	Every riser 9.5 in (24 cm) or less	☐	☐	☐	
21	Headroom Ref. 1910.25(d)(3)	6 ft 6 in (2 m) or more above each tread, taken at its front edge	☐	☐	☐	
22	Tread depth Ref. 1910.25(d)(4)	7.5 in (19 cm) or more, measured 12 in (30 cm) out from the narrow edge	☐	☐	☐	
23	Tread size Ref. 1910.25(d)(5)	All treads the same size	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Ship stairs and alternating tread-type stairs

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
24	Ship stair slope Ref. 1910.25(e)(1)	Slope measures 50 to 70 degrees from horizontal	☐	☐	☐	
25	Ship stair risers Ref. 1910.25(e)(2)	Risers are open (no riser boards)	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Ship stairs and alternating tread-type stairs

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
26	Ship stair rise Ref. 1910.25(e)(2)	Vertical rise between tread surfaces is 6.5 to 12 in (17 to 30 cm)	☐	☐	☐	
27	Ship stair tread depth Ref. 1910.25(e)(3)	Each tread 4 in (10 cm) deep or more	☐	☐	☐	
28	Ship stair tread width Ref. 1910.25(e)(4)	Each tread 18 in (46 cm) wide or more	☐	☐	☐	
29	Alternating tread slope Ref. 1910.25(f)(1)	Tread series slopes at 50–70 degrees from horizontal	☐	☐	☐	
30	Handrail spacing Ref. 1910.25(f)(2)	Handrails 17 to 24 in (51 to 61 cm) apart	☐	☐	☐	
31	Alternating tread depth Ref. 1910.25(f)(3)	Each tread 8.5 in (22 cm) deep or more	☐	☐	☐	
32	Open risers on shallow treads Ref. 1910.25(f)(4)	Risers are open wherever tread depth is under 9.5 in (24 cm)	☐	☐	☐	
33	Alternating tread width Ref. 1910.25(f)(5)	Each tread 7 in (18 cm) wide or more at the nosing	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME

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